

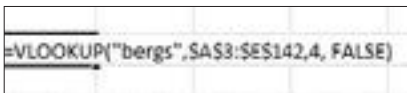
The grouping added by the Subtotal Routine is based on the number of sort levels used. In our example of the performance of the salesmen in an organisation, the result of a Summarising operation will have a three-level grouping, with the product group nested in the monthly group nested in the Salesmen group.

4.5 Using Indexed Data

A spreadsheet can be indexed, or sorted, by using any of the columns as the sort key. After a spreadsheet has been indexed, it becomes easier to look up information in it. While this would be easy in case of small spreadsheets, large spreadsheets would require a lot of scrolling or repeated use of the Find and Select tool. Excel packs in two functions that automate the index lookup process.

4.5.1 The VLOOKUP and HLOOKUP Functions

VLOOKUP is a function that looks up a user-specified value in the first column of a cell range, and



returns the value of any cell in the same row. For example, if the details of the students of a class is stored in a table, with the table being sorted on the Students' Roll Number, and the other columns being Name, Age, Address, VLOOKUP can be used to return the Address of a student by providing his Roll Number.

The syntax of VLOOKUP is

VLOOKUP(Value to Lookup, Cell Range, Column Offset of cell to be returned, Type of lookup toggle).

The "Value to Lookup" can be Text, Number, or a Logical result.

The "Cell Range" is the reference to the range that has the column containing the value to be looked up as the first column.